**89. In the Mekong-Ganga Cooperation, an initiative of six countries, which of the following is/are not a participant/participants?**

1. Bangladesh
2. Cambodia
3. China
4. Myanmar
5. Thailand

**Select the correct answer using the code given below:**

**(a) 1 only**
**(b) 2, 3 and 4**
**(c) 1 and 3**
**(d) 1,2 and 5**

**Ans : (c)** The Mekong-Ganga Cooperation (MGC) comprises six member countries, namely India, Thailand, Myanmar, Cambodia, Laos and Vietnam. They emphasised four areas of cooperation, which are tourism, culture, education, and transportation linkage. The organisation takes its name from the Ganga and the Mekong, two large rivers in the region. Hence option (C) is correct.

**90. 'Basel III Accord' or simply 'Basel III', often seen in the news, seeks to–**

(a) develop national strategies for the conservation and sustainable use of biological diversity
(b) improve banking sector's ability to deal with financial and economic stress and improve risk management
(c) reduce the greenhouse gas emissions but places a heavier burden on developed countries
(d) transfer technology from developed countries to poor countries to enable them to replace the use of chlorofluorocarbons in refrigeration with harmless chemicals

**Ans : (b)** According to the Basel Committee on Banking Supervision, 'Basel III is a comprehensive set of reform measures, developed by the Basel Committee on Banking Supervision, to strengthen the regulation Supervision and risk management of the banking sector'. Basel III or Basel 3 released in December, 2010, is the third in the Series of Basel Accords. These accords deal with risk management aspects for the banking sector.

**91. With reference to 'Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation (IOR-ARC)', consider the following statements :**

1. It was established very recently in response to incidents of piracy and accidents of oil spills.
2. It is an alliance meant for maritime security only.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Ans : (d)** Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation (IOR-ARC) is an international organisation consisting of coastal states bordering the Indian Ocean. The organisation was first established as the Indian Ocean Rim Initiative in Mauritius in March 1995 and formally launched on 6-7 March 1997. It aims to promote the sustained growth and balanced development of the region and of the member states and to create common ground for regional economic co-operation.

**92. With reference to `Forest Carbon Partnership Facility', which of the following statements is/are correct?**

1. It is a global partnership of governments, businesses, civil society and indigenous peoples.
2. It provides financial aid to universities, individual scientists and institutions involved in scientific forestry research to develop eco-friendly and climate adaptation technologies for sustainable forest management.
3. It assists the countries in their `REDD+ (Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation+)' efforts by providing them with financial and technical assistance.

**Select the correct answer using the code given below:**

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

**Ans : (c)** The first Carbon Partnership facility is a global partnership of governments, businesses, civil society and Indigenous peoples focused on reducing emissions from deforestation and forest degradation, forest carbon stock conversation, the sustainable management of forests, and the enhancement of forest carbon stocks in developing countries (activities commonly referred to as REDD+). It assists countries in their REDD+ efforts by providing them with financial and technical assistance in building their capacity to benefit from possible future systems of positive incentives for REDD+. It does not provide direct financial aid to universities, individual scientists and institutions.

**93. Which one of the following was given classical language status recently?**

(a) Odia
(b) Konkani
(c) Bhojpuri
(d) Assamese

**Ans : (a)** Odia on 24th February, 2014, became the sixth language of the country to get 'classical language' status after the Union cabinet conceded a long-pending demand for putting it in the same league as Sanskrit, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada & Malayalam. Current classical languages in India are Tamil (2004), Sanskrit (2005), Telugu (2008), Kannada (2008), Malayalam (2013), Odia (2014).

**94. `Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action', often seen in the news, is–**

(a) a strategy to tackle the regional terrorism, an outcome of a meeting of the Shanghai Cooperation Organization
(b) a plan of action for sustainable economic growth in the Asia-Pacific Region, an outcome of the deliberations of the Asia-Pacific Economic Forum
(c) an agenda for women's empowerment, an outcome of a World Conference convened by the United Nations
(d) a strategy to combat wildlife trafficking, a declaration of the East Asia Summit



**Ans : (c)** The 'Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action (BPFA) is an international declaration of women's rights set up at the UN & landmark Fourth World Conference on Women, held in Beijing (China) in 1955 . The BPFA covers 12 key critical matters of concern and areas for action including women and poverty, violence against women and access to power and decision making. It completed its 20 years in 2015 and hence was in the news.

**95. Consider the following countries :**

1. China
2. France
3. India
4. Israel
5. Pakistan

**Which among the above are Nuclear Weapons States as recognized by the Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons, commonly known as Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT)?**

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1, 3, 4 and 5 only
(c) 2, 4 and 5 only
(d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5

**Ans : (a)** The United States, United Kingdom, France, Russia, and China are nuclear- weapon states according to the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty. It is noteworthy that the above five countries are permanent members of the United Nations Security Council. Four other states are known or believed to possess nuclear weapons: India, North Korea, Pakistan and Isreal. They declared that they possess nuclear weapons.

**96. With reference to bio-toilets used by the Indian Railways, consider the following statements :**

1. The decomposition of human waste in the bio-toilets is initiated by a fungal inoculum.
2. Ammonia and water vapour are the only end products in this decomposition which are released into the atmosphere.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Ans : (d)** Under the bio toilet concept of the DRDO. The decomposition of human waste in the bio-toilets is initiated by a bacterial inoculums (and not fungal). Carbon dioxide and Methane are the end products released into the atmosphere. When human excreta comes in contact with bacteria, it gets converted into methane and water through a series of steps of anaerobic digestion-hydrolysis, acidogenesis, acetogenesis and methanogenesis. Hence option (d) is correct.

**97. `Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana' has been launched for–**

(a) providing housing loan to poor people at cheaper interest rates
(b) promoting women's Self-Help Groups in backward areas
(c) promoting financial inclusion in the country
(d) providing financial help to the marginalized communities

**Ans : (c)** Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) is a National Mission for Financial Inclusion to ensure access to Financial Services, namely, banking/Saving & Deposits Accounts, Remittance, Credit, Insurance, Pension in an affordable manner. The account can be opened in any bank branch or Business Correspondent (Bank Mitra) outlet. This financial inclusion campaign was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on 28th August, 2014.

## MISCELLANEOUS

**98. Amnesty International is–**

(a) an agency of the United Nations to help refugees of civil wars
(b) a global Human Rights Movement
(c) a non-governmental voluntary organization to help very poor people
(d) an inter-governmental agency to cater to medical emergencies in war-ravaged regions

**Ans: (b)** Amnesty International is a non-governmental organisation. It was founded in London in July 1961 by Peter Benenson. In the field of Human Rights organisation. Amnesty has the longest history and broadest name recognition and is believed by many to set standards for the movement as a whole. It is 7 million members and supporters around the world.

**99. Kalamkari painting refers to–**

(a) a hand-painted cotton textile in South India
(b) a handmade drawing on bamboo handicrafts in North-East India
(c) a block-painted woollen cloth in Western Himalayan region of India
(d) a hand-painted decorative silk cloth in North-Western India

**Ans : (a)** Kalamkari (Kalam=Pen, Kari= work) literally means artwork done using a Pen. Vegetable dyes are used to colour the design applied on cloth. The art of painting using organic dyes on cloth was popular in several parts of India, but this style of Kalamkari flourished at Kalahasti and at Masulipatnam. The Kalamkari tradition chiefly consists of Scenes from Hindu mythology. Figures of deities with rich border embellishments were created for the temples. Here option (a) is correct.

**100. With reference to the Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA), which of the following statements is/are correct?**

1. It is a Public Limited Government Company.
2. It is a Non-Banking Financial Company.

**Select the correct answer using the code given below:**

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Ans : (c)** IREDA is a Public Limited Government Company established as a Non-Banking Financial Institution in 1987 under the administrative control of MNRE to promote, develop and extend financial assistance for renewable energy and energy efficiency/conservation projects. Both the statements are correct.